



POCO X2 confirmed for India

The highly-awaited POCO X2 is officially confirmed by the company and will launch on February 4 in India. <https://digit.in/feb20-61>



Apple's Curved Mac patent

Apple has applied for a patent for a new Mac where the body is made out of a curved screen of glass. <https://digit.in/feb20-62>

Sapphire Pulse AMD Radeon RX 5600 XT

Beats the RTX 2060 in performance but not value

The Sapphire Radeon RX 5600 XT is the absolute souped-up version from among all the partner cards. Let's take a closer look at the Sapphire Radeon RX 5600 XT. The configuration of the RX 5600 XT GPU is the exact same as the RX 5700. It's basically the exact same GPU with slightly lower clocks for the reference model. The only physical difference is that the memory has been reduced by 2 GB and accordingly has a reduced bus-width owing to the fewer memory chips connected.

Build

The Sapphire Pulse AMD Radeon RX 5600 XT that we received looks very much like the Sapphire Pulse RX 5700. It sports a twin blower design with the shroud being open on all sides. There are plenty of large vents on the backplate and the underside of the GPU is also exposed. The topside is partially open and we can see two spots for 8-PIN power connectors of which only one is populated. Towards the I/O plate, we see a small cut-out where the vBIOS switch is present. It comes with three DisplayPorts and one HDMI port.

Removing the backplate reveals a fairly unpopulated underside of the PCB. The finstack is as big as the card with negligible overhang. It's got three heatpipes spread evenly throughout. The PCB design is nearly identical to the Sapphire Pulse Radeon RX 5600 XT aside from the two fewer memory chips and the power connector.

Synthetic Benchmarks

In 3DMark Time Spy and Fire Strike, the RX 5600 XT easily outperforms the RTX 2060 and even comes close to RTX 2070 after the new BIOS was released.



Price
₹23,588

Gaming Benchmarks

These are the benchmarks with the new BIOS. We tested the usual set of games at 1080p, 1440p and 4K resolutions. In Battlefield V, the RX 5600 XT performs approximately 30 per cent better than the RTX 2060 at 1080p, 6 per cent at 1440p and 11.6 per cent at 4K. However, other games don't enjoy this large a performance gap. Strange Brigade showcases an improvement of 10-12 per cent at 1440p and 4K, however, there were a few runs where the RX 5600 XT was about 22 per cent ahead of the RTX 2060 but the average was around 15 per cent. The Witcher 3 worked in NVIDIA's favour with the RTX 2060 being ahead by 9-10 per cent at 1080p and 1440p whereas at 4K it was 5 per cent ahead.

Overall, it's evident that the RX 5600 XT has a decent advantage over the RTX 2060. NVIDIA has the obvious advantage of having hardware-accelerated ray-tracing but we're still to see wide adoption of the technology.

Overclocking

The overclocking tool built into the Radeon software is quite versatile and easy to use. In the case of the Sapphire Radeon RX 5600 XT, we have the highest clocked RX 5600 XT configuration

so the overclocking limits were also the highest as of now. The peak boost clock is 1820 MHz and the peak memory clock is 1860 MHz with the voltage level being 1.050V. In its default configuration with the new BIOS, we scored 7612 in Time Spy. When using the automatic overclocking feature, this went up to 7669. And with the manual overclock with all parameters set to the absolute maximum, the score jumped to 7836 points.

Value for money

The RX 5600 XT is doomed in India because of its Indian pricing. The cheapest RX 5600 XT we found was a GIGABYTE RX 5600 XT for ₹26,199, which is more expensive than the RTX 2060 that it aims to replace. To calculate the value we averaged out the synthetic performance and gaming performance separately and then pegged it against

the current actual market price. The RX 5600 XT is better than the RTX 2060 at synthetic benchmarks. When it comes to gaming, the RTX 2060 is ahead because it's priced lower and the FPS delta isn't large enough to warrant the price premium that the RX 5600 XT commands.

Verdict

The Sapphire Radeon RX 5600 XT is no doubt one of the only RX 5600 XT cards you should get since it features better build quality and can handle higher memory clocks. The fact that the RX 5600 XT only equals a 1.5 year old RTX 2060 doesn't help much. This card is a great performer in the mid-range segment but AMD really needs to work on its regional pricing.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

STREAM PROCESSORS: 2304 | CU: 36 | BOOST CLOCK: 1560 MHz | VRAM: 6 GB GDDR6 | BUS-WIDTH: 192-bit | CONNECTORS: 1x8PIN | TBP: 150W

CONTACT

AMD (ADVANCED MICRO DEVICES) | PHONE: Web form | EMAIL: Web form | WEBSITE: www.amd.com



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